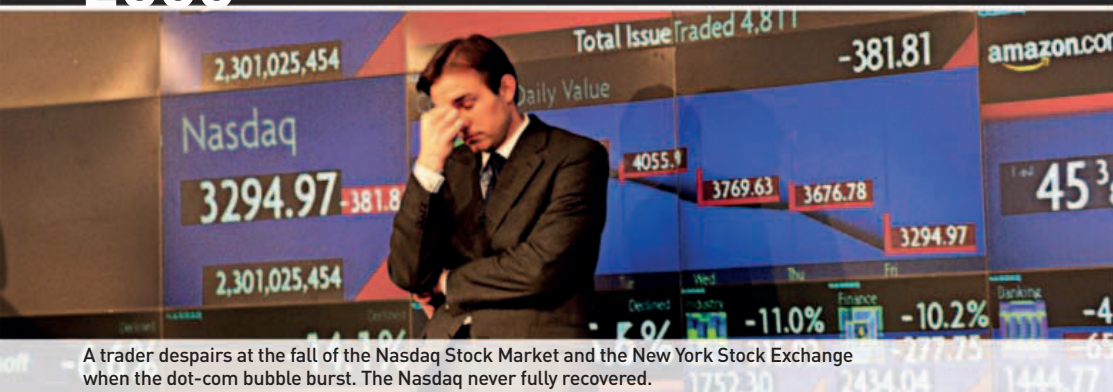




A trader despairs at the fall of the Nasdaq Stock Market and the New York Stock Exchange when the dot-com bubble burst. The Nasdaq never fully recovered.



Millennium celebrations

Fireworks explode in a spectacular display over Sydney Harbor Bridge and Opera House as Australia welcomed in the new millennium.

Israel announced its withdrawal from South Lebanon in May, 22 years after occupying it. The occupation had become unpopular with the Israeli electorate.

North and South Korea held a summit in June, the first since the peninsula was divided in 1945. The South Korean president Kim Dae-jung received the **Nobel Peace Prize** for his efforts.

More than 800 followers of a **Ugandan cult** known as the Restoration of the Ten Commandments of God died in their churches in March. It is uncertain whether they committed mass suicide or were murdered by the leaders of the cult.

The year ended in bloodshed as a series of terrorist bombs went off on December 30 in the **Philippines**. They became known as the **Rizal Day bombings** because of the national holiday celebrated on this day.



2:1 First crew of ISS
The *International Space Station* received its first crew in 2000. The crew was composed of three men: two Russians and one American.

IN JANUARY, THE UN WAR CRIMES TRIBUNAL in The Hague sentenced five Bosnian Croat militiamen to 25 years in prison for a 1993 murder spree that emptied a Bosnian village of all its Muslim inhabitants during the Bosnian War (1992–95).

Opposition supporters from Serbia stormed the Yugoslav parliament building in Belgrade on October 5 using a **bulldozer**, proclaiming **Vojislav Kostunica** as the new Yugoslav president after discrepancies in September elections caused outrage. President **Milosevic** announced his resignation the next day.

In 1991, **Denmark** and **Sweden** agreed to build a bridge connecting the two countries. The 10-mile (16-km) long **Oresund Link**—

running between the Danish capital, Copenhagen, and the Swedish port of Malmö—was opened to traffic this year.

In March, stock markets around the world crashed when internet companies began to fail and the **dot-com bubble**, caused by speculative investment into internet-based companies, **burst**.

Antiglobalization **protestors** descended on Prague in September during meetings between the **World Bank** and the **International Monetary Fund**. The police presence was huge, and more than 600 people were injured in riots.

The first crew arrived at the **International Space Station** in November, with NASA astronaut Bill Shepherd as commander.



George W. Bush was elected president of the US in 2001. Here he shakes hands with Al Gore, the defeated Democrat candidate, outside the US Capitol in Washington.

\$11 BILLION THE AMOUNT OF MONEY LOST BY ENRON SHAREHOLDERS

THE REPUBLIC OF MACEDONIA WAS ON THE BRINK OF WAR

in March, as ethnic Albanian rebels demanding equal rights clashed with government forces. In August, NATO announced it would send a **peacekeeping force** to this former Yugoslavian republic.

The US experienced an unprecedented day of terror on **September 11**, when 19 al-Qaeda terrorists hijacked four passenger airlines. Two flew into the twin towers of the **World Trade Center**, another into the **Pentagon**. The fourth crashed into a field near Pittsburgh. Nearly 3,000 people were killed. These events left America, and the world, in a profound state of shock. The devastating impact of what became known simply as "**9/11**," September 11, prompted President Bush to declare a "**war on terror**." NATO met the day after the attacks, offering full support and invoking a Cold War-era treaty clause that stated when one member is attacked; all members are attacked.

Only a week after 9/11, letters containing **anthrax** spores were mailed to several news offices and two Democratic US Senators. Five people died and a further

17 were infected. The suspect committed suicide.

In October, the US and Britain launched attacks on targets in **Afghanistan**, where **Osama Bin Laden** (1957–2011), head of the militant Islamic organization al-Qaeda, was believed to be hiding. Operation "**Enduring Freedom**" aimed to remove the Taliban regime and replace it with a democratic government.

Large parts of the world were tipped into **recession** after the 9/11 terror attacks, and many in the business community were mourning deceased colleagues. Economic problems worsened when **Enron**, an American power-trading company, went bust in December in the world's biggest corporate collapse.

In December, **Argentina** plunged into financial ruin. The government announced that its foreign debt could not be paid back and billions of dollars in government spending would be cut.

Another attempted terrorist attack occurred toward the end of the year. **Richard Reid**, a British passenger flying from Paris to Miami, was caught trying to light a fuse protruding from his **shoe**. Reid, an Islamic fundamentalist

